

FinMate

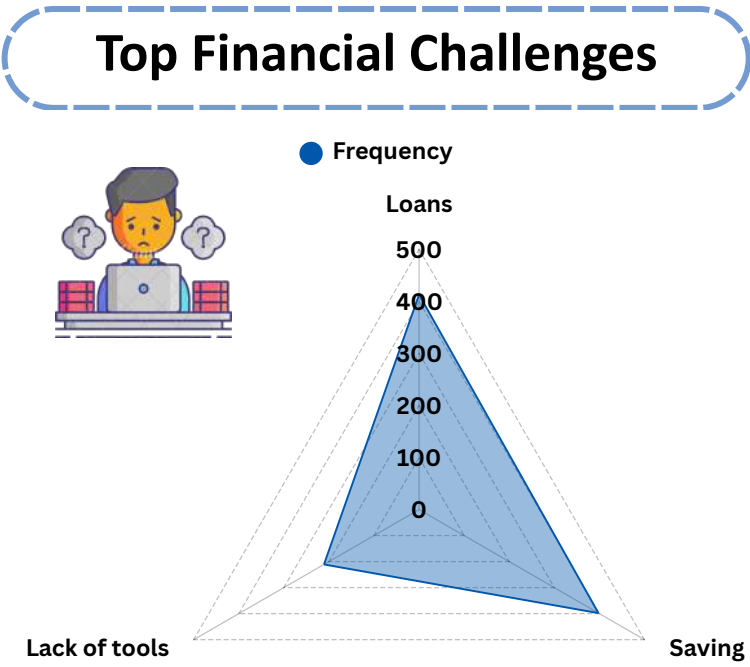
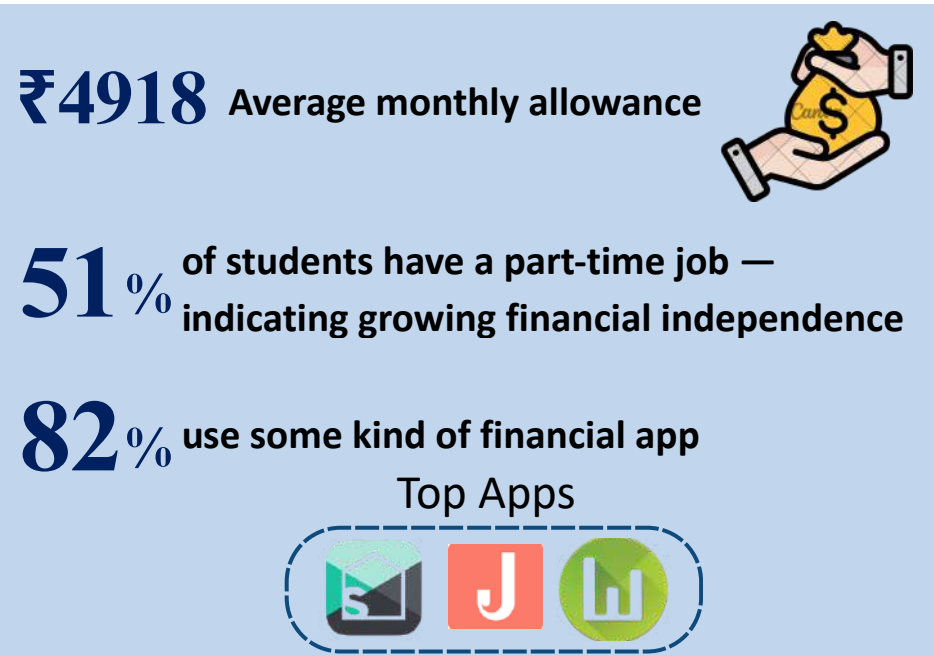
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Produscope

Market Research

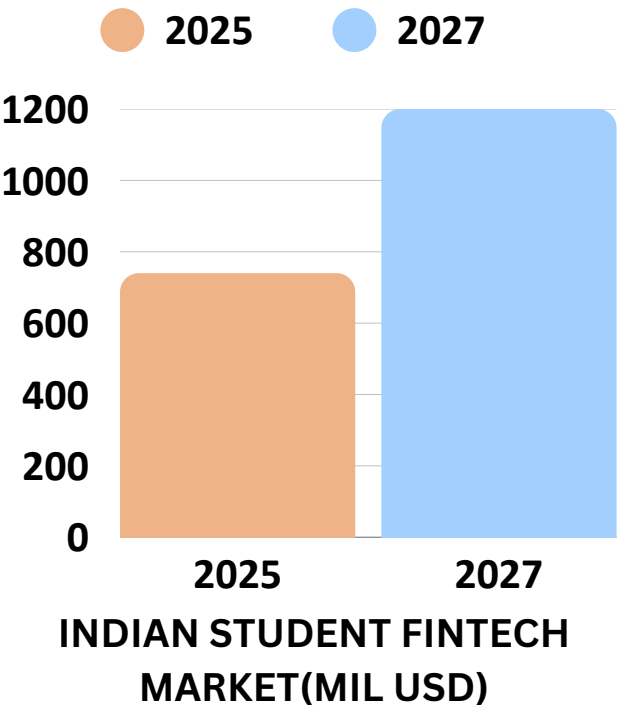
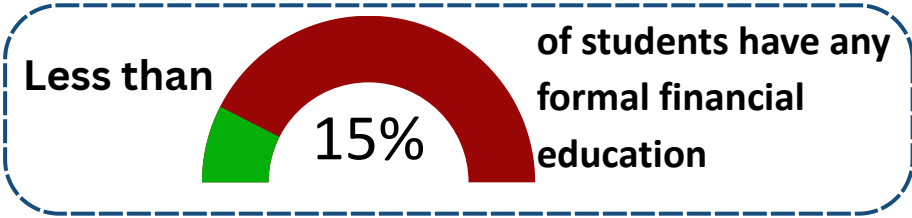
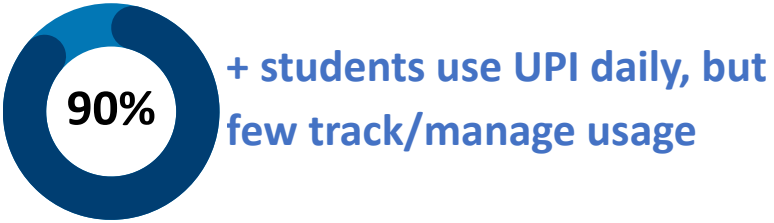
PRIMARY RESEARCH- Summary of Findings from 1,000 Indian Students



SECONDARY RESEARCH

40M+ college students in India

Monthly discretionary spend: **₹3K–₹8K**



CLUSTER-BASED SEGMENTS AND PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

CLUSTER	KEY TRAITS	PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS
Financially Proactive	100% have part-time jobs - Heavy users of apps like Splitwise, Jupiter, Walnut - Avg monthly allowance: ₹4782	Launch with advanced features like savings rules, budgeting insights, and loan planners
Dependent but App-Savvy	- Fully dependent on parental allowance - Still active on finance apps - Avg monthly allowance: ₹4920	Focus on goal-based savings, and allowance tracking with peer tools
Non-Digital Planners	- No app usage - Highest avg allowance: ₹5218 - Mixed job status	Target with simple onboarding, habit nudges, and clear value prompts for savings/trackers

MARKET TRENDS



High UPI Usage Lacks Financial Tracking

While **UPI** is ubiquitous among students, few apps help with **tracking, budgeting, or insights tied to spending.**



Rollout of Loan Reforms

With **education loan approval** cycles shrinking, there's a promising window for **fintechs** to **integrate instant loan planning**



Smaller Towns Remain Underserved

Innovative fee systems that bypass credit checks are **empowering students** in smaller towns



Huge Growth in Alternative Lending

Rapid growth in retail lending creates a **fertile ground** for **student-specific micro-loan products**

Primary Research Deep Dive

Analysis of 1,000 Indian college students - Translating financial behaviour into FinMate’s MVP priorities



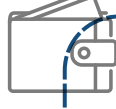
1,000+
college students analysed



Avg. monthly allowance:
₹4,918

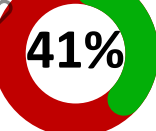


**51%**
have a part-time job

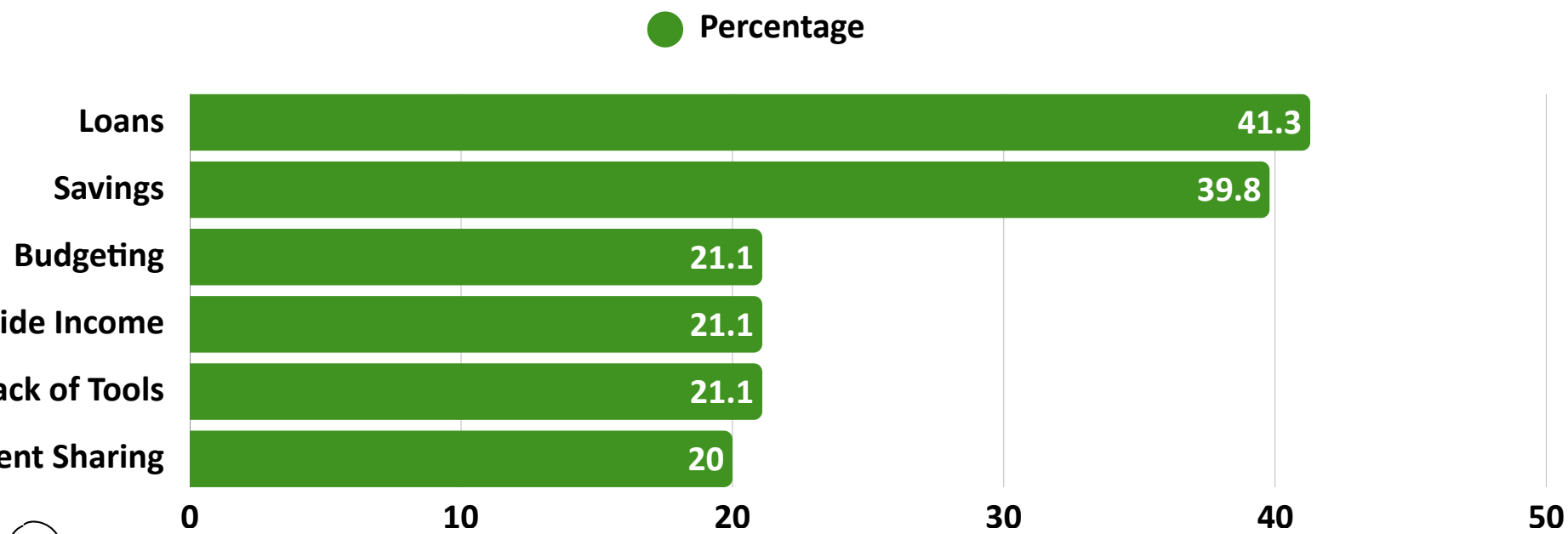


**82%**
already use a finance app



**41%**
list loans among top-3 money challenges

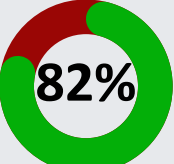
TOP MONEY CHALLENGES



 Saving and loan-related concerns clearly dominate, while budgeting, side-income management, tooling and shared expenses form the next layer of unmet student needs.

KEY INSIGHTS

**Digital First ≠ Problem Solved**

**82%**
already use finance apps, yet key money-management gaps remain.

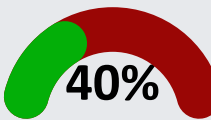
→ Win through student-specific workflows

**Needs Vary by Income Source**

Part-time earners show higher side-income/tooling needs, while non-earners need more budgeting support.

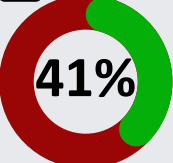
→ Use personalized onboarding, trackers and nudges.

**Saving: Universal Need**

**40%**
list Saving among their Top-3 challenges

→ Smart Savings Pods as a core MVP feature.

**Credit: a Roadmap Opportunity**

**41%**
include Loans among their Top-3 challenges

→ Validate demand first, then introduce Campus Score / micro-credit post-MVP.

HOW FINANCIAL NEEDS SHIFT WITH ALLOWANCE

**Low Allowance — ₹2K–₹3K**

- **38.3%** Saving
- **37.1%** Loans
- **22.4%** Expense-control / emergency concerns

→ Focus: Expense visibility + savings discipline

**Mid Allowance — ₹4K–₹5K**

- **43.0%** Saving
- **41.5%** Loans
- **25.2%** Budgeting — highest across bands

→ Focus: Budget planning + Savings Pods

**High Allowance — ₹6K–₹8K**

- **38.8%** Saving
- **44.4%** Loans — highest across bands
- **23.5%** Rent sharing

→ Focus: Shared expenses + future credit tools

Problem Analysis

Solutions

User Journey

Implementation
and Impact

User Persona

Understanding the pain points of our users



About

Hostel Student “Riya” (18, Tier-2 College)
Lives in hostel, depends entirely on monthly allowance from parents.

“Arjun” (20, Metro City College)
Travels from home, earns part-time via tutoring & freelancing.

“Amit” (22, Final Year)
About: Stays in shared PG with 3 roommates; manages rent, utilities, and groceries collectively.



Pain-Points



Struggles with mid-month cash shortage.



No visibility on where money is going (canteen, outings, snacks).



Rent/fees reminders create stress.



Income is irregular & unpredictable.



Hard to track side hustle earnings vs. allowance.



Peer pressure spending → overshoot.



Constant friction in rent splits and reimbursements.



Missed deadlines → landlord mistrust.



No credit history → blocked from credit card/education loan eligibility.



Goals



Stretch monthly allowance till month-end without borrowing.



Track and control small daily spends (canteen, outings).



Consolidate allowance + side hustle income in one view.



Systematically save for big-ticket items (laptop, trip, bike).



Avoid overspending (peer pressure)



Build a credit history before graduation.



Reduce conflicts with roommates/landlord over payments.



Motivation



Recognition as “responsible” among friends.



Wants financial discipline as a life skill for the future and reduce stress of constantly asking parents for extra.



Desire for independence from parents.



Wants to feel like he’s “earning and managing his own life.”



Wants peace of mind from automated payments.



Sees credit score as an enabler for future loans/credit cards.

Competitor Analysis

Analysis different strengths and weakness of competitors

TOP 5 PLAYERS	CORE FOCUS	STRENGTHS	UNADDRESSED	TARGET AUDIENCE	ENGAGEMENT LEVEL
 Splitwise	Group expense splitting	Easy roommate/group splitting, integrates with UPI	No budgeting, saving, or financial guidance	Working professionals, roommates, friend group	Very High (frequent use among roommates)
	Neobank for Gen Z & young professionals	Smart UI, UPI, debit card, spend tracking	Not tailored for students, no rent/mess flow, no gamification	Gen Z job starters, early professionals	High (active user community + regular updates)
	Smart banking + expense analytics	Rich insights, rewards, goals	Too professional, steep learning curve for first-year students	Professionals, salaried users	High (strong content + rewards + utility)
	Pocket money + UPI + teen wallet	Parental control, nudges, intuitive UI	No peer-based finance, not built for independent hostel/campus living	High-schoolers, early UG students, parents	Medium (high among school/early UG)
	Gamified saving	Savings via games/lotteries, high engagement	No budgeting, no group features, no clarity tools	General savers, college students casually saving	Medium (growing via referrals and games)

Feature Identification

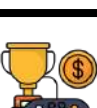
Prioritizing the features of the app keeping in mind the problems faced by students

PROBLEM UNDERSTANDING

Problems Faced by Students

- Irregular & Untracked Allowances
- Low Savings Discipline & No emergency Buffer
- Frequent Conflicts in Shared Living Expenses
- Uncontrolled Peer Pressure Spending
- Financial Illiteracy & Short term Thinking
- Inability to handle Unexpected Cash Gaps
- Limited Earning Opportunities

R.I.C.E. Prioritization Method

Feature	Reach (R)	Impact (I)	Confidence (C)	Effort (E)	R.I.C.E Score
 Quick Onboarding & Allowance Setup	100	12345	95%	12345	76000
 Smart Auto-Savings Pods	80	12345	85%	12345	102000
 Behavior Nudges & Money Lessons	85	12345	85%	12345	43350
 College Expense Tracker	90	12345	90%	12345	97200
 Gamified Money Missions	75	12345	80%	12345	72000
 Roommate Rent Split Wallet	60	12345	80%	12345	96000
 Instant Micro-Credit	50	12345	70%	12345	87500
 Side Income Tracker	65	12345	70%	12345	54600

Other Key Features

Driving digital financial inclusion through key features

SMART BUDGETING + PREDICTED BURN RATE

ML-driven foresight transforms the student app from a passive tracker into an active financial advisor, reinforcing daily engagement and trust.



Problem

60–70% of students **exhaust allowances** before month-end due to poor foresight & peer-driven overspending. **Lack of predictive tools** → leads to reliance on loans or parental bailouts mid-cycle.



Our Solution

ML-powered forecasting engine to predict allowance depletion date. Personalized nudges & suggestions based on real-time spending.

Model: **MLP(Multi Layer Perceptron)**

Inputs:

- Daily spend patterns
- Rent/recurring expense cycles
- Peer cluster spending benchmarks
- Past savings behavior



Output: Actionable Insights

- “At current pace, you will run out of allowance by 23rd.”
- “Reduce outings by ₹500/week to stay within budget.”

P2P LENDING CIRCLES

P2P Lending circles will help the community to be made enforcing larger monthly active users and helping students with money run-outs.



Problem

>60% of students borrow informally from peers for short-term needs (fest fees, emergencies, rent). No enforcement → leads to defaults, conflicts, and loss of trust.



Our Solution

Closed-loop P2P lending circles within verified university groups (University ID / email validated). App automates contribution, disbursement, and repayment tracking.

How It Works

- Student applies for micro-loan within campus circle.
- Peers contribute (like a rotating savings pool).
- App ensures transparent disbursement & repayment reminders.
- **Default history affects student’s Campus Score.**



Why It Matters

- Builds trust-based credit ecosystem inside universities.
- Embeds app deeper into student community networks, making it indispensable

CAMPUS SCORE & MICRO CREDIT LOANS

Students are unable to take loans because of absence of credit score; this feature will enable registered campuses to give loans.



Problem

~80% of Indian students graduate without a credit history, limiting access to loans, rentals, and credit cards.



Our Solution

Build early credit identity for students through two layers: **Credit Builder:** Small, secured micro-loans (₹1,000–₹5,000) repaid via the app and reported to bureaus.

Campus Score: Internal gamified score based on: Inputs:

- Savings patterns
- Rent/roommate contributions
- Repayment of app-issued micro-loans

Processing:

Internal algorithm aggregates data into a Campus Score (0–1000).

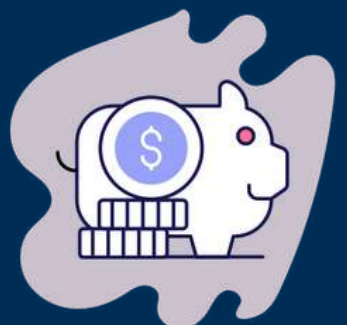
Optional reporting of repayment history to bureau (via NBFC partner).



Output: Actionable Insights

- “Your Campus Score: 720 – You qualify for pre-approved ₹10,000 NBFC loan.”
- “Maintain 3-month savings streak → +20 score boost.”

ONBOARDING SETUP.



Know your vibe → We'll learn your fashion & beauty style to tailor every recommendation

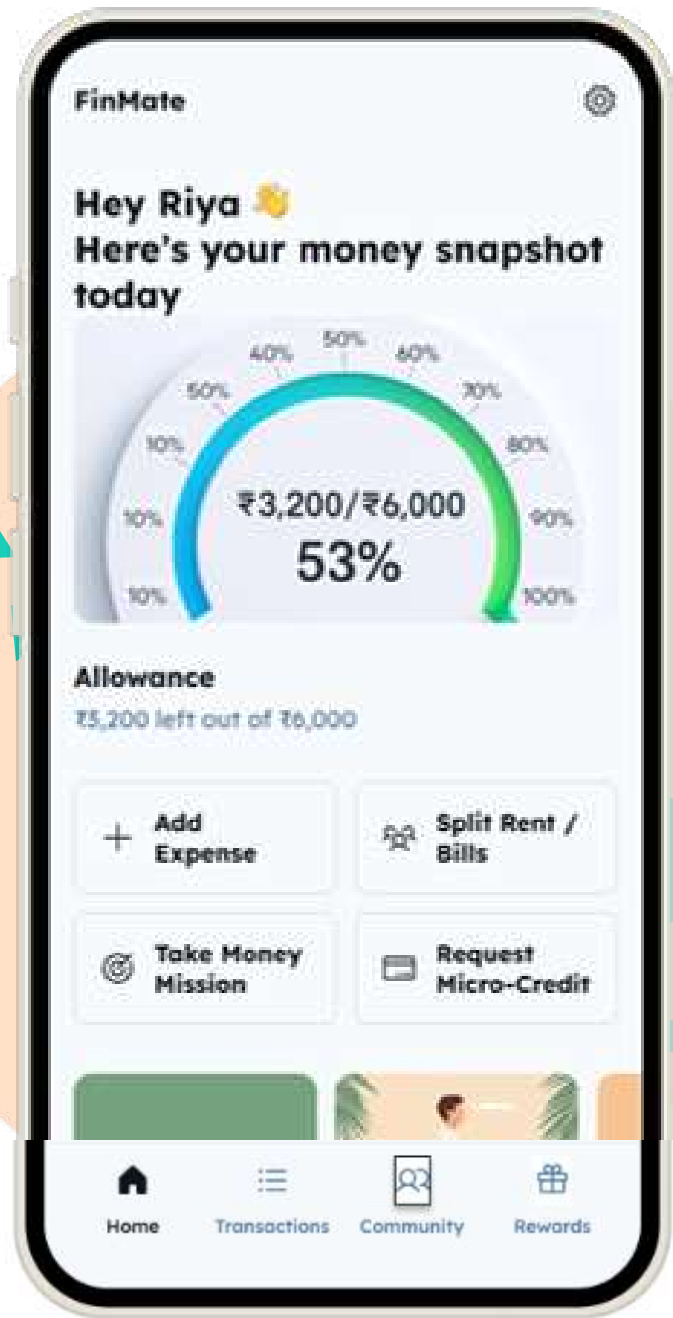
Finmate

Smart Money for Students

Monthly allowance range

Lifestyle Quick Tags

Part-time job?



Curated styles → Mix & match outfits and beauty picks aligned with your personal aesthetic

FinMate

You spent 25% less than peers this week

70% of your Emergency Fund goal achieved

At t allo out

Savings Tips

Switch to mess for 2 more days = save ₹400 this week

Delay headphone purchase by 2 weeks → cover exam fees stress-free

Set aside ₹50/day → ₹1,500 saved by month end

Home

Transactions

Community

Rewards

Smart picks = Best fit for budget → Personalized brands, clothing & cosmetics you'll actually love — without overspending

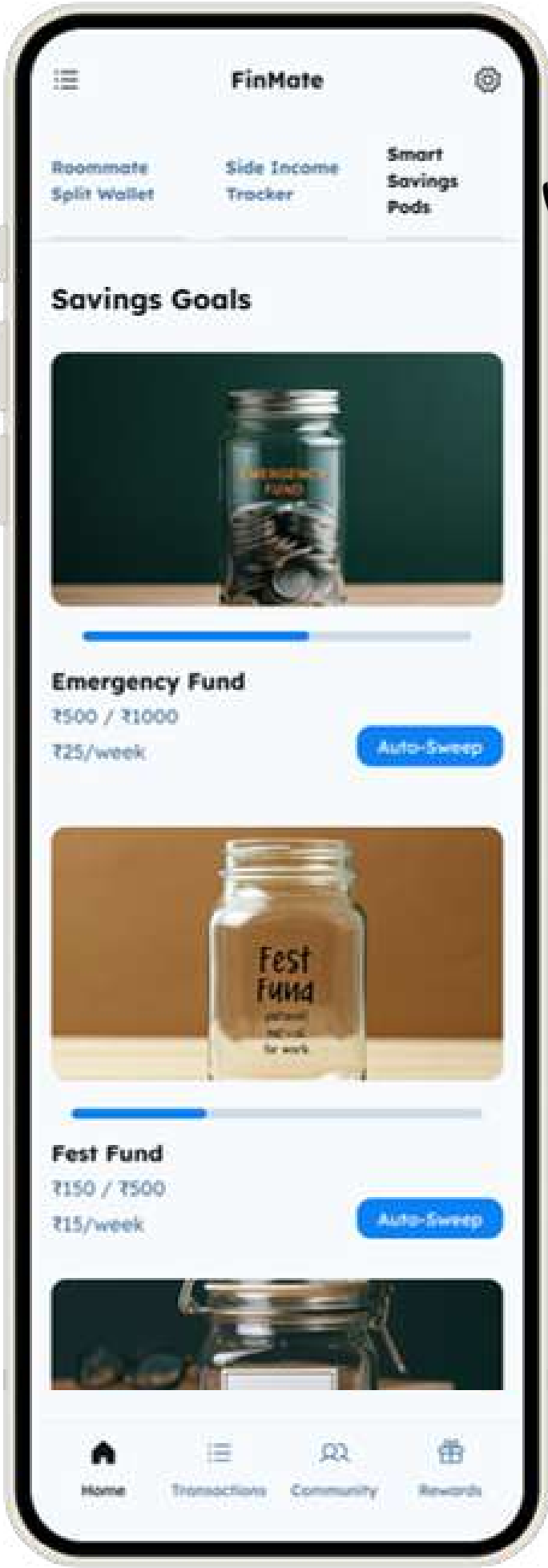
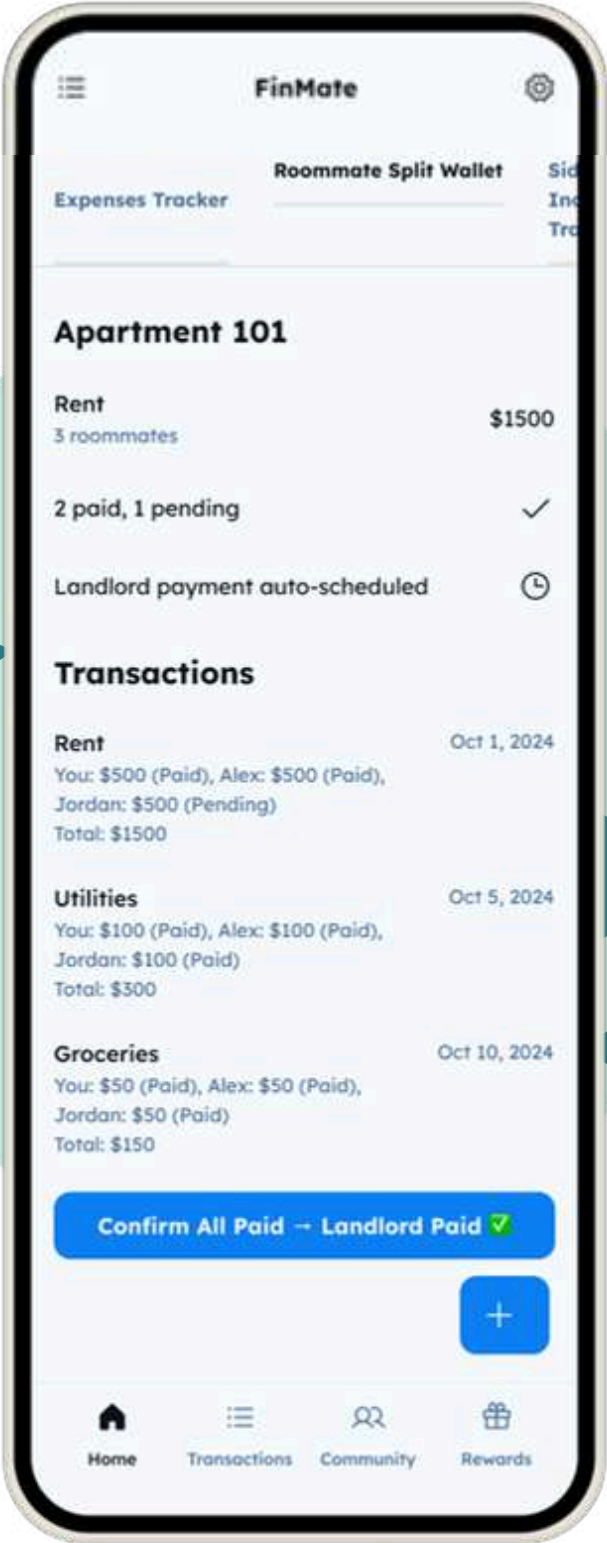
Problems faced by most of the Students:

Escrow wallet pools roommate payments to avoid friction.

- 1 **The Three Options for Autopay :**
UPI AutoPay Mandates – fully automated, RBI rails, but high onboarding friction.
- 2 **Wallet Auto-Debit (via PPI partner)** – gamified, familiar, but requires top-ups.
- 3 **Escrow Release Model (virtual pooled account)** – manual UPI in, auto lump-sum out, landlord gets receipt.



Recommendation: Start with Escrow Release Model (lowest friction, regulatory-light).
Phase 2: Add UPI mandates for stickiness.
Phase 3: Wallet auto-debit with gamified top-ups.



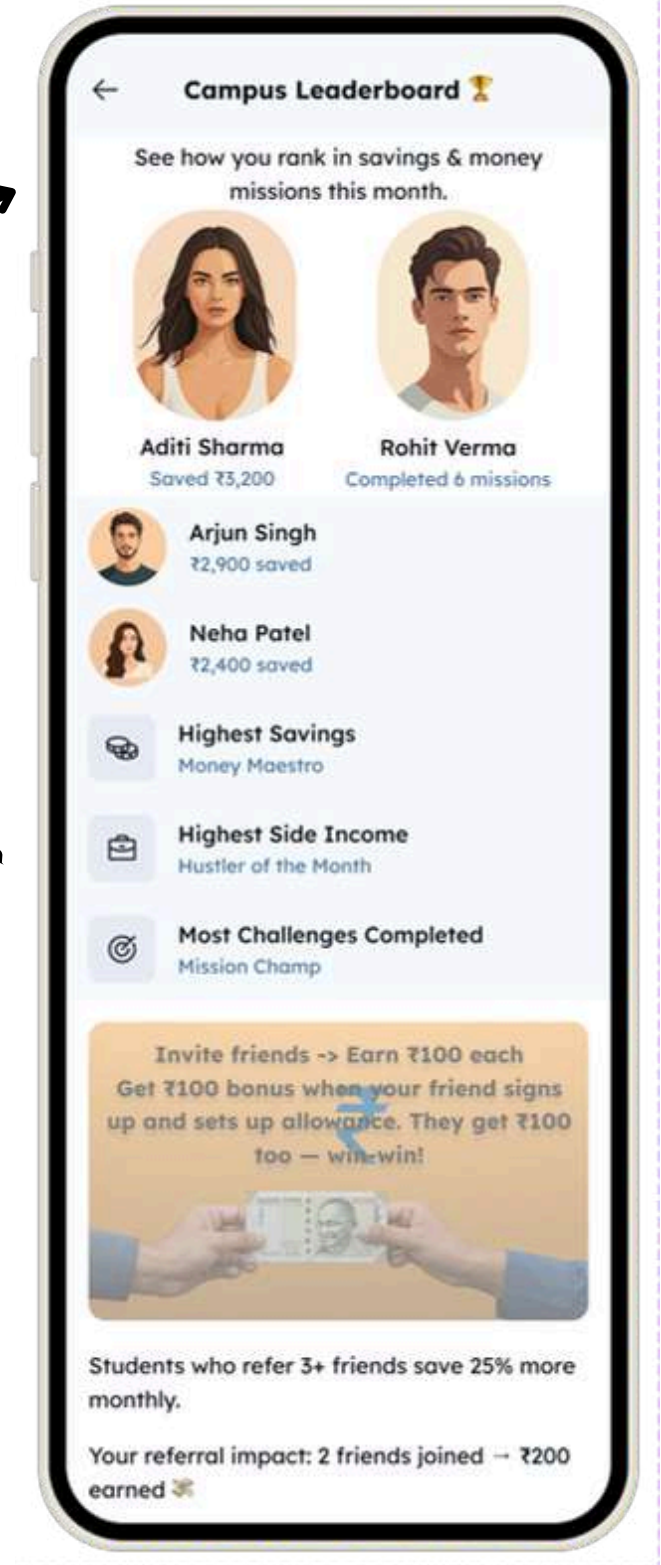
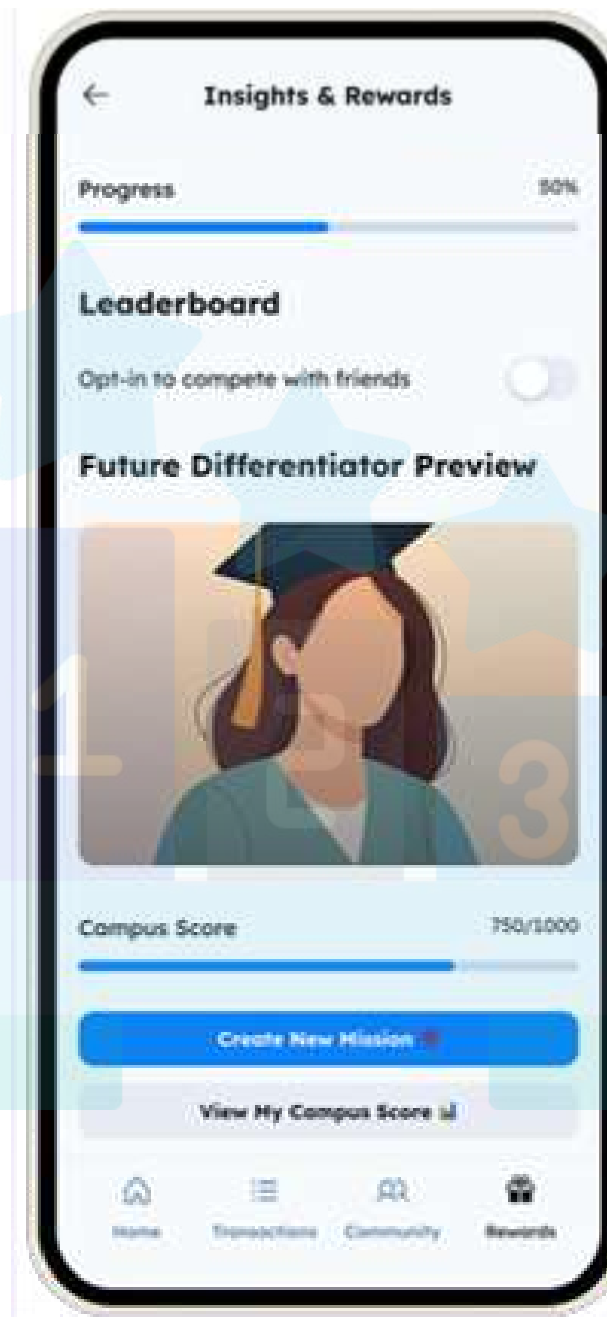
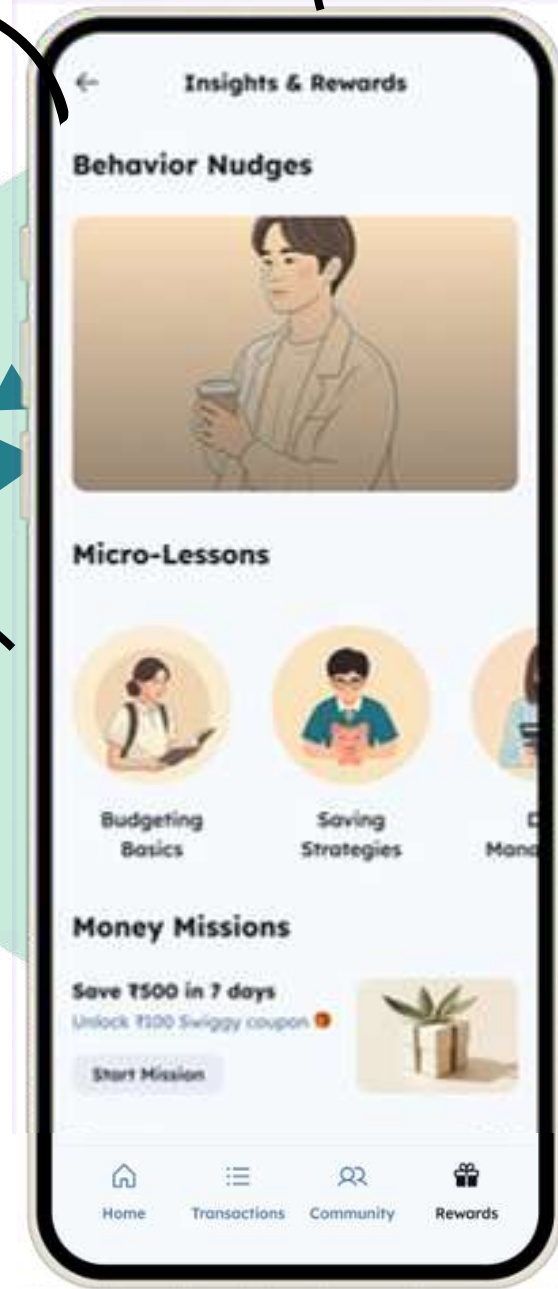
Motivating to Save for a specific goal to avoid last minute run outs.

Builds habit without feeling the pinch. Increasing RETENTION.

Students using goal-based pods save ~30% more vs. unplanned savings.



SCROLL



Build student credit with small app-based loans and a gamified Campus Score reflecting savings, contributions, and repayments.

Gamified savings and budgeting with missions, rewards, and leaderboards to encourage consistent money-saving habits.

Problem:

Financial literacy is low → impulsive spending is high.

Solution:

Contextual nudges + bite-sized lessons embedded in app journey.

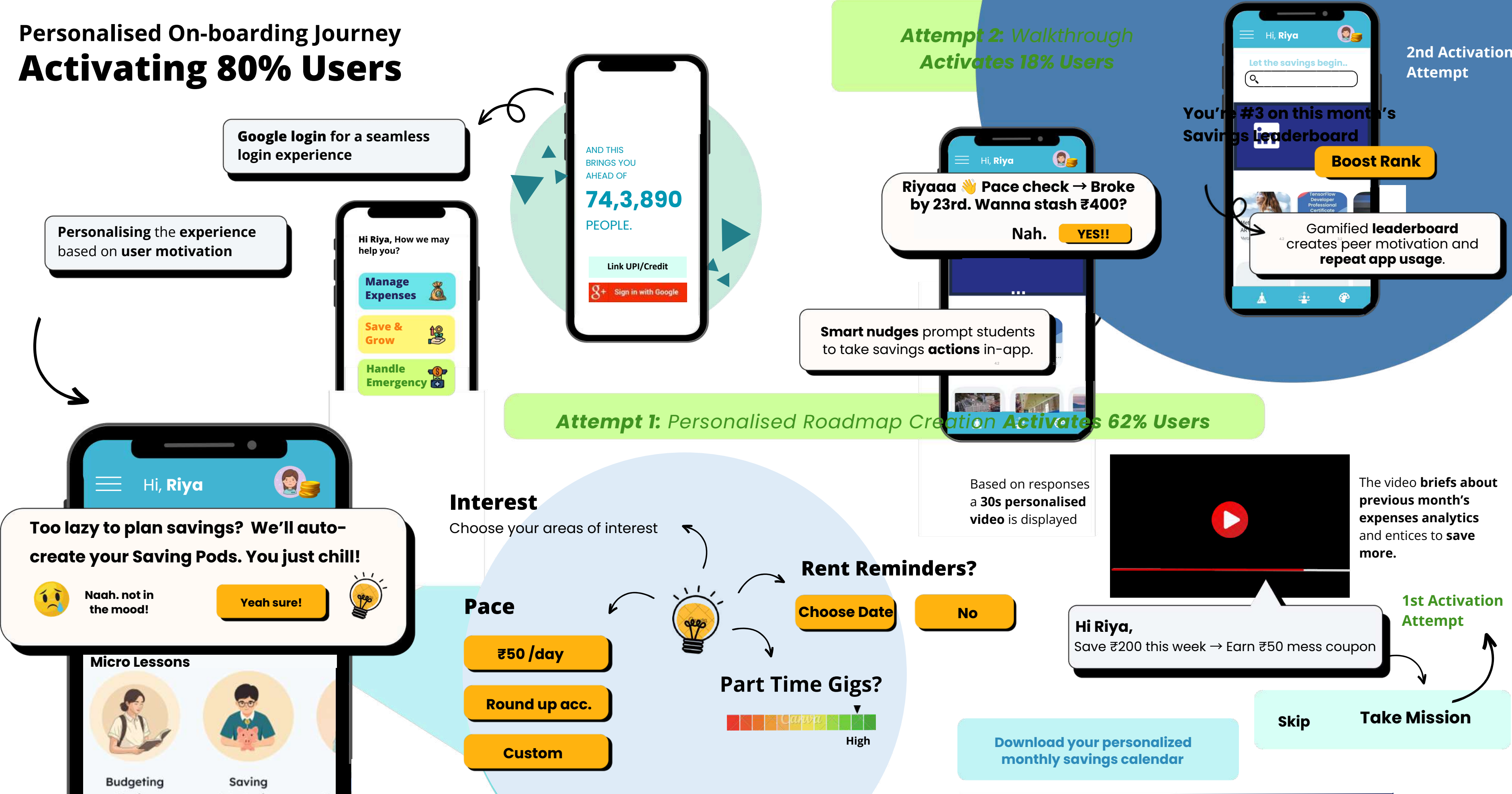
Micro-lessons:

30-sec “Did you know?” finance tips.

Why it matters?

Moves students from reactive to proactive money habits.

Personalised On-boarding Journey
Activating 80% Users



Problem Analysis

Solutions

User Journey

Implementation
and Impact

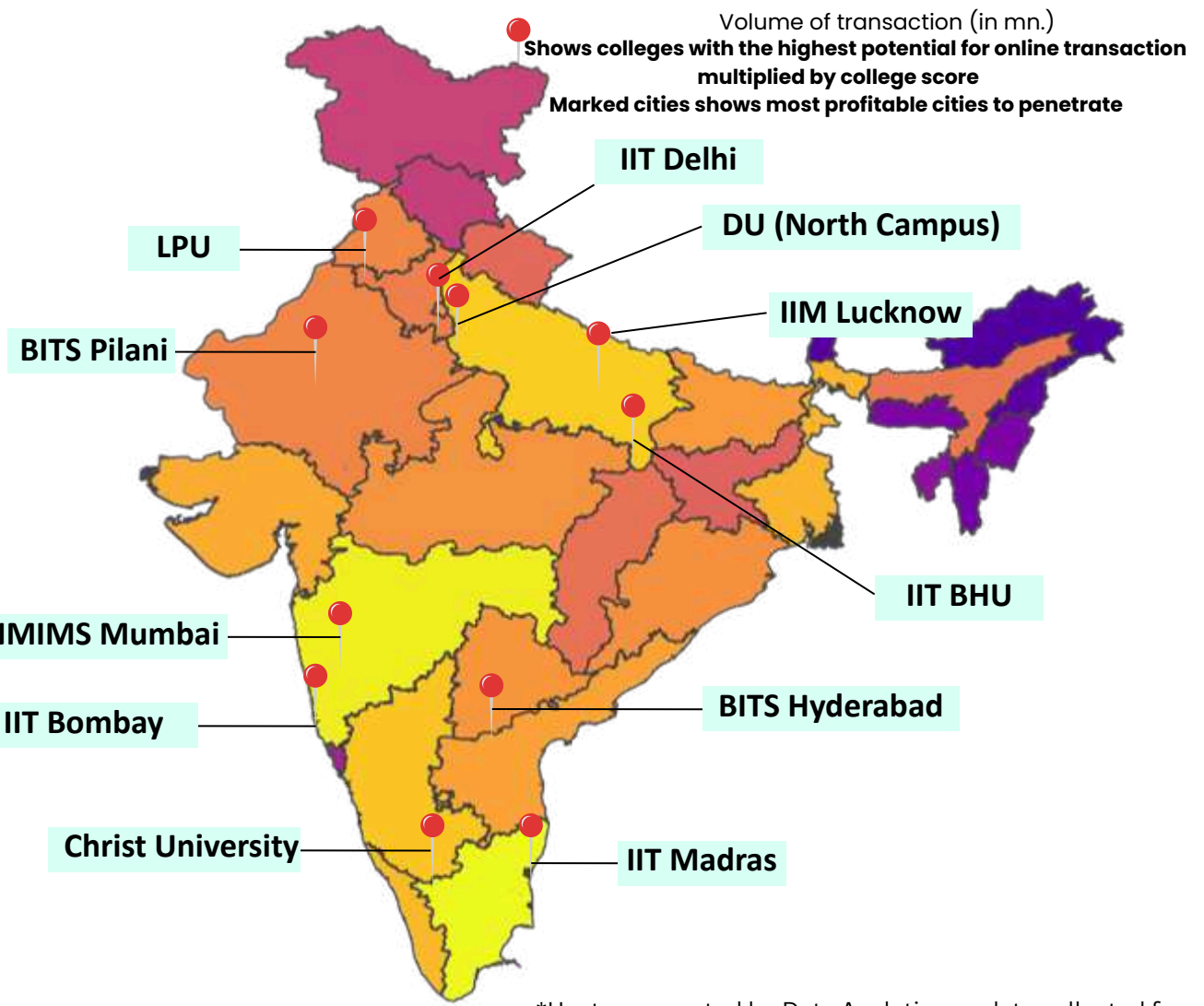
Top 3 colleges Rollout

Finding a balanced trio of Scale + Credibility + Tech Adoption, de-risking the rollout.

Deep Dive
in Appendix

TIMELINE AND PHASES

100 200 300 400 500 600



*Heatmap created by Data Analytics on data collected from NPCI Website over past 3 years

“College selection is indirectly guided by UPI transaction density — the higher the volume of digital transactions in a region, the stronger the need for students to actively manage money, making those campuses ideal testbeds.”

CAMPUS SPECIFIC PLAYBOOK



Christ Uni



Launch Tactics:
PG-area activations in Koramangala, BTM, Indiranagar.
QR posters and referral incentives for PG owners/landlords.



Gamified challenges at **Youth Fests & Societies**.
WhatsApp campaigns via student leaders and **PG wardens** with **exclusive invites**.



- Core Hooks**
- Rent Wallet → **critical** for Koramangala **PG students**.
 - Gamified Pods → leaderboard & missions to **build stickiness**.
 - **Micro-credit adoption** → aspirational middle-class users **want credit access**.

DU (North Campus)



Launch Tactics:
Ambassador program across 10 top colleges (SRCC, Hindu, Hansraj, **Miranda House**, Kirori Mal, etc.).



On-ground stalls in **Kamla Nagar & Hudson Lane PG clusters**.
Tie-ups with **major fests** (Mecca, Crossroads, Renaissance) for **student funnel**.



- Core Hooks**
- **Rent Wallet** → group sign-ups in PGs, pooled rent escrow.
 - **ML Burn Forecasts** → daily nudges on “days left” for allowance.
 - Pods → **savings challenges** between flatmates.

NMIMS Mumbai



Launch Tactics:
Highly engaging branded stalls organized at flagship NMIMS cultural fests (Umang, Vaayu, Vaudeville).



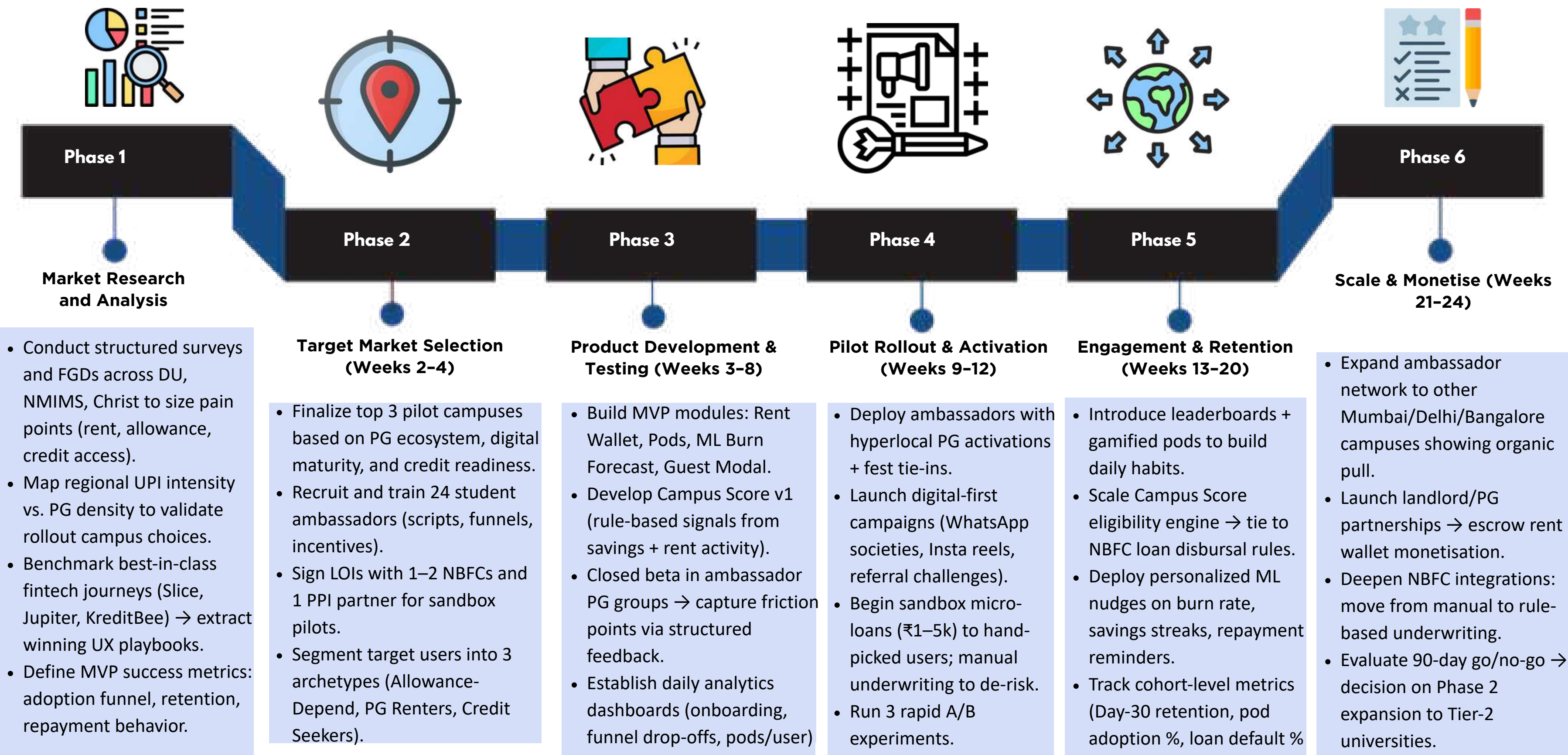
In-class demos in popular finance /management core courses.
Strong finance club tie-ups (Investment Cell, FinTech Leadership Club).



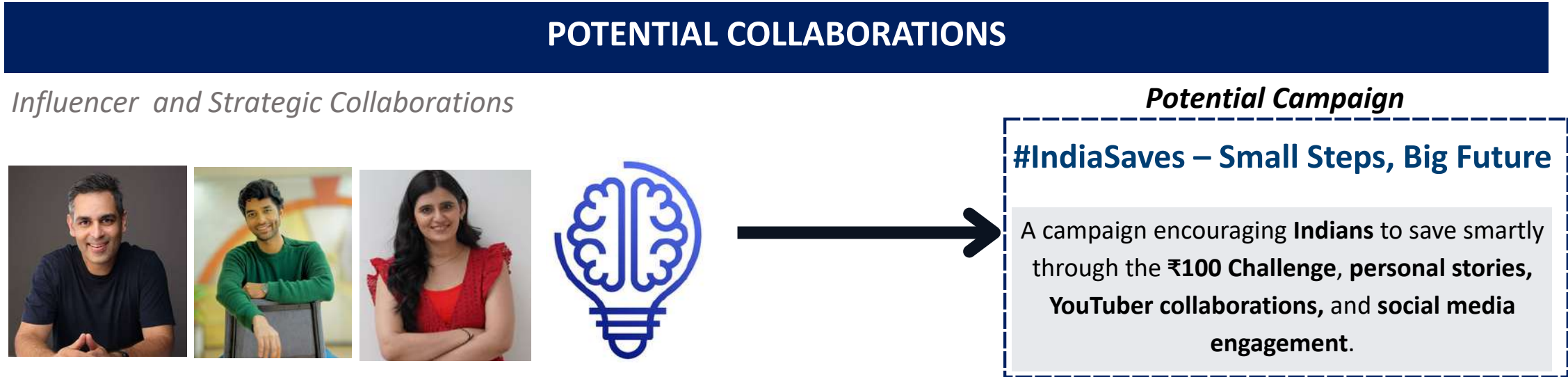
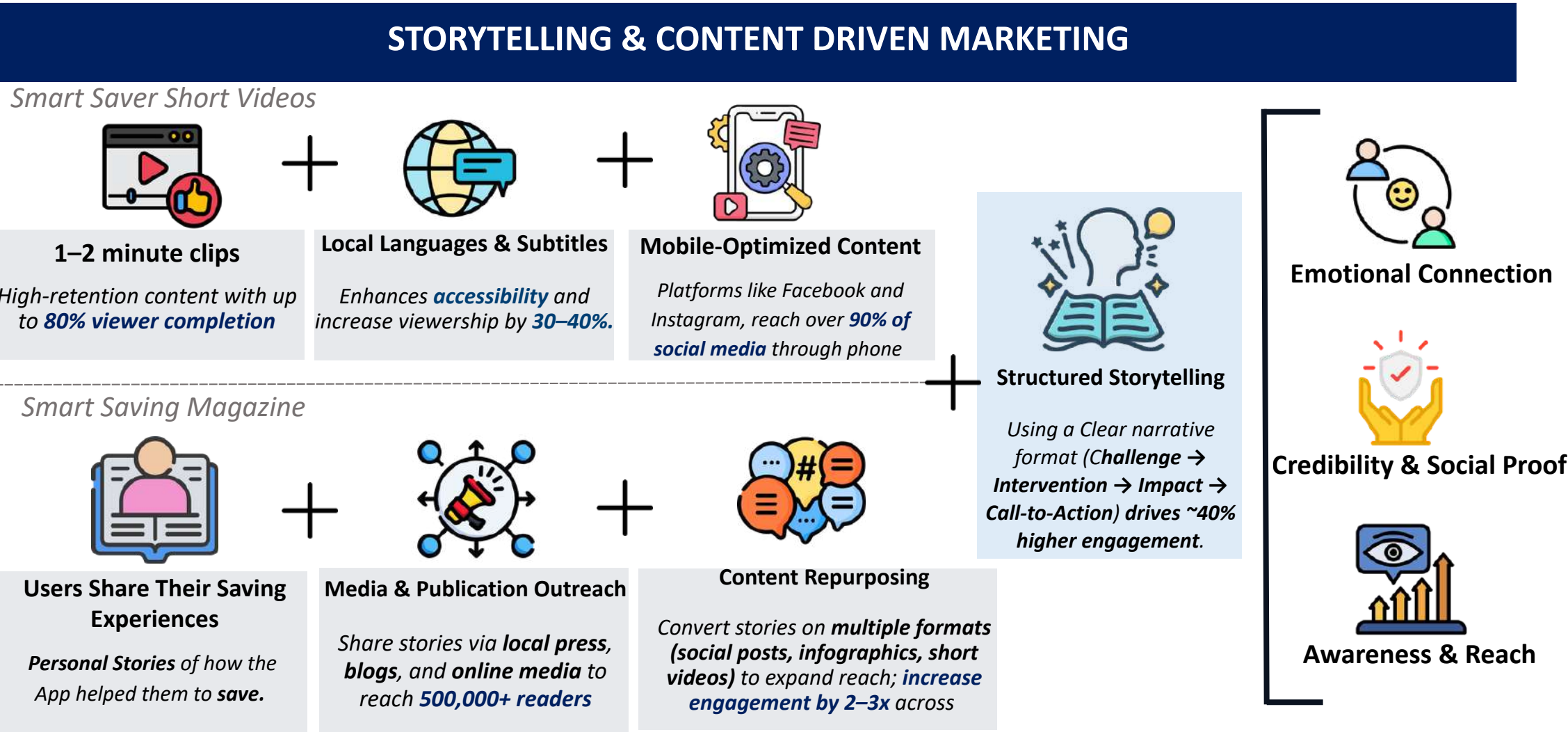
- Core Hooks**
- Campus Credit Score → gamified digital profile building for loans.
 - Micro-loans pilot with leading NBFC partner (₹5–10k).
 - Side Income Tracker → useful for freelancers.

Roadmap for 6 Months

How will actually things go in to the market?



Marketing Strategies



Success KPIs and Challenges

Helps measure the impact of our solutions in the real world

Student Metrics

- Onboarding completion rate (target: 80%)
- Time to first expense entry / rent split (target: <7 days)
- User retention rate after 60 days (target: 65%)
- Average savings pod utilization (target: 2+ pods per student)
- % of students building emergency fund (target: 40%)

Roommate & Community Metrics

- Rent split completion on time (target: 90% by due date)
- Conflict reduction (self-reported disputes) (target: -50%)
- Average group size per rent wallet (target: 3+)
- Leaderboard participation rate (target: 50% of active users)

Credit & Finance Partner Metrics

- Micro-credit application completion rate (target: 70%)
- Time to loan disbursal (₹500–₹5,000 range) (target: <24 hours)
- Default/NPA rate (target: <5%)
- Cross-sell conversions to partner products (FDs, SIPs) (target: 15%)
- Credit score building adoption (target: 30% of senior students)

Overall Platform Metrics

- Monthly Active Users (MAU) growth (target: 10% MoM)
- Transaction volume processed (target: ₹50 Cr GMV in Year 1)
- Average session duration (target: 10 mins/day)
- Daily mission completion rate (gamification) (target: 60%)
- Platform uptime (target: 99.9%)

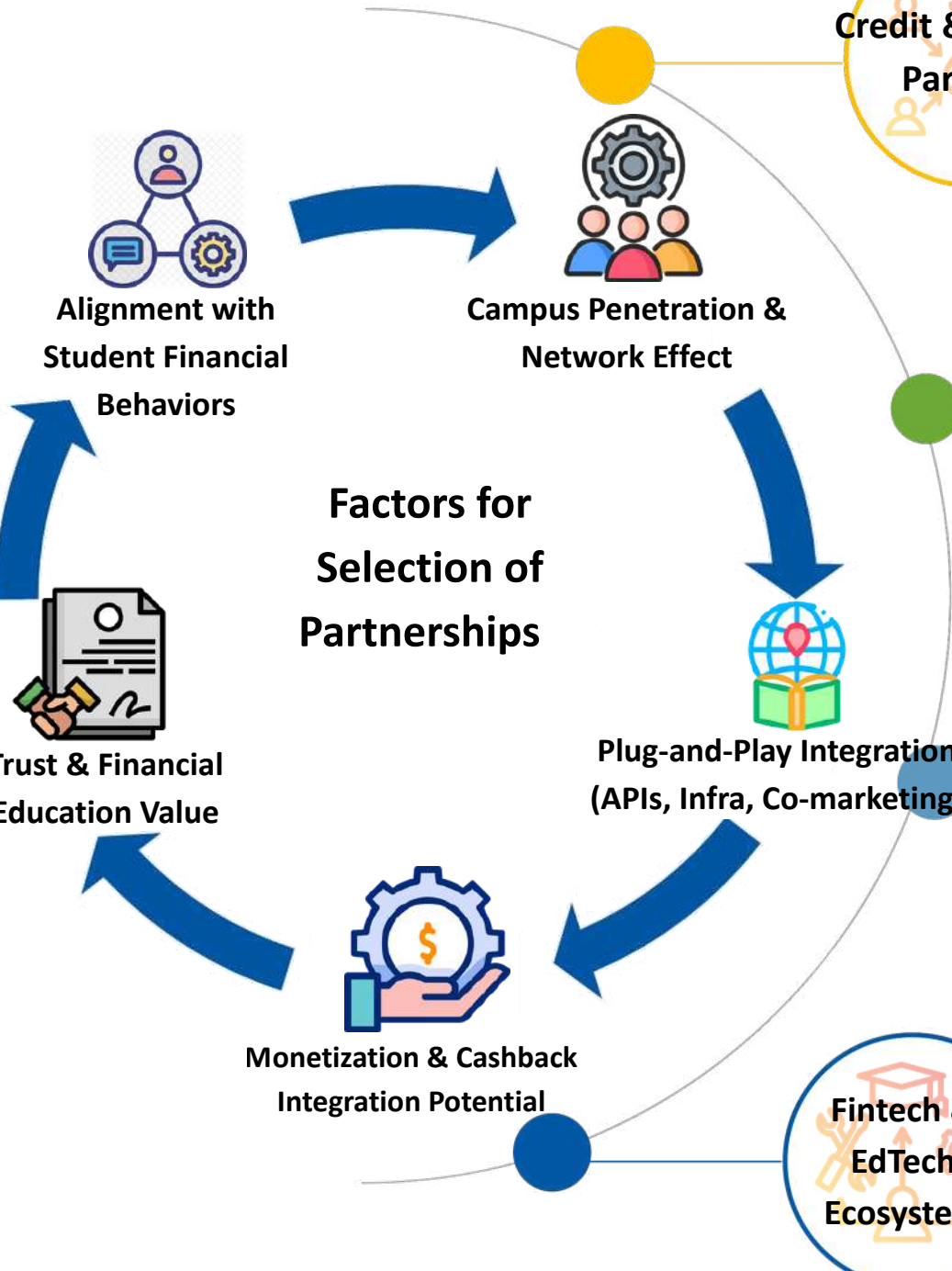
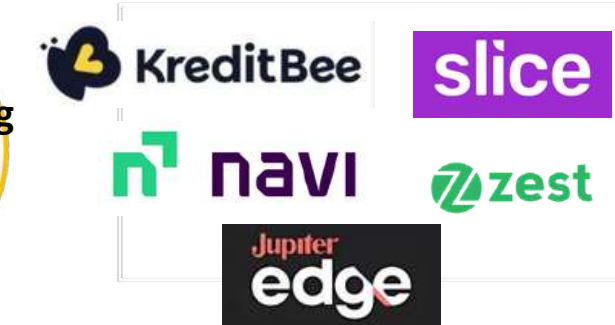
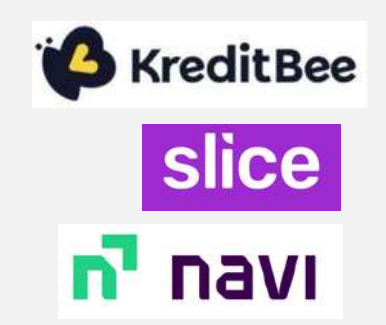
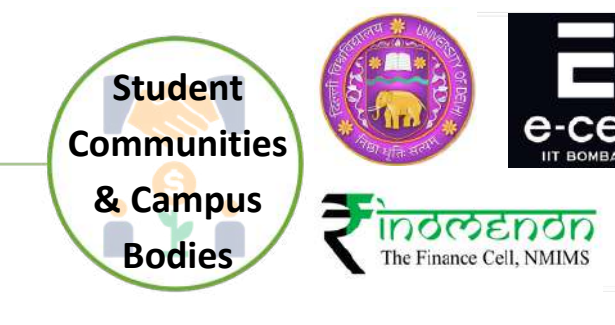
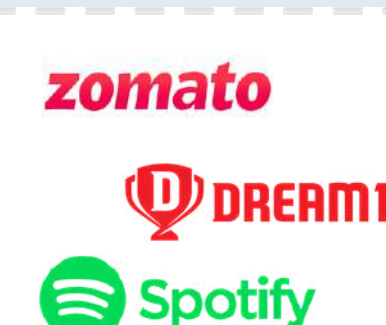
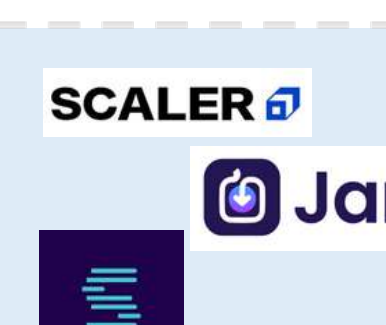
KEY CHALLENGES:

- Building trust with students & parents around money handling.
- Regulatory hurdles for wallets/escrow/UPI AutoPay.
- Driving engagement beyond expense logging (avoid churn).
- Managing credit risk while offering micro-credit.
- Ensuring cybersecurity & fraud prevention in P2P transfers.
- Bridging digital literacy gaps for Tier-2/Tier-3 colleges.
- Scaling infra to handle spikes during rent/bill cycles.
- Balancing fun gamification with serious financial credibility.

Appendix

Partnerships

Activating student-first fintech growth through NBFCs, campuses, and youth ecosystems.

Potential Partnerships		Rationale	Suggested Partnerships
 Factors for Selection of Partnerships	Credit & Lending Partners 	Partner with NBFCs and credit infra providers to pilot a rent-tracking model where consistent, on-time rent payments through the app contribute toward building a student's credit profile. <i>Expected to increase early credit adoption by 30–40% and improve repayment consistency in hostel settings within 12–18 months.</i>	
	Student Communities & Campus Bodies 	Engage directly with finance clubs, placement cells, and fest organizers for credibility, pilot reach, and co-creation of features (e.g., score-based loan access, budgeting case studies). <i>Enhances student trust, increases credibility by 25–30% in early adopters, and boosts word-of-mouth activation.</i>	
	Lifestyle & Youth Brands 	Enable co-branded savings rewards with food delivery, quick commerce, and gaming apps. Gamify milestones like “no overspending,” “rent paid on time,” with real-world brand coupons and wallet cashbacks. <i>Expected to increase app engagement by 30–50% and drive viral growth among digitally active students.</i>	
	Fintech & EdTech Ecosystem 	Leverage India's growing BaaS, embedded finance, and edtech tools to plug in financial scores, micro-credit access, or course-linked rewards. Also drive brand trust through responsible lending and skill-building. <i>Drives operational efficiency up to 25% and increases in-app educational engagement.</i>	



College	PG / Rent Fit	Digital Maturity	Credit Readiness	Activation Potential	Prestige / Partner	Scalability	Total
Delhi Univ. (North)	5	4	5	5	4	5	28
NMIMS Mumbai	5	5	5	4	5	4	28
Christ Univ. (Bangalore)	5	5	4	5	4	4	27
IIT Bombay	2	5	4	5	5	4	25
IIT Delhi	3	5	4	4	5	4	25
IIT Madras	2	4	4	4	5	4	23
BITS Pilani	1	4	3	4	5	3	20
BITS Hyderabad	1	4	3	3	4	3	18
IIM Lucknow	1	4	4	2	5	2	18
LPU (Punjab)	2	3	3	3	3	5	19

Solutions In Depth

ROOMMATES RENT SPLIT



Problem: Shared rent/bill payments cause friction, missed deadlines, and landlord mistrust.



Solution: Pooled digital wallet/escrow for roommates → one clean lump-sum to landlord.

The Three Options for Autopay:

1

UPI AutoPay Mandates – fully automated, RBI rails, but high onboarding friction.

2

Wallet Auto-Debit (via PPI partner) – gamified, familiar, but requires top-ups.

3

Escrow Release Model (virtual pooled account) – manual UPI in, auto lump-sum out, landlord gets receipt.



Recommendation: Start with Escrow Release Model (lowest friction, regulatory-light).
Phase 2: Add UPI mandates for stickiness.
Phase 3: Wallet auto-debit with gamified top-ups.

SMART SAVING AUTO PODS



Problem: Students lack savings discipline, spend allowance too fast.

Solution: Auto-sweep into themed pods (Emergency, Fest, Exam).

Micro-savings triggered via round-ups, daily auto-sweeps.
Visual progress jars → behavioral nudge to save.

Creates sticky savings behavior → Drives retention + opens cross-sell of FDs, SIPs, insurance.

SIDE INCOME TRACKER

Problem: Students juggle part-time gigs, tutoring, freelance work → no single view of earnings.

Solution: Track side income streams inside the app (cash + UPI + transfers).

Auto-categorizes: gigs, tutoring, delivery, freelance.
Builds a Campus Income Profile → useful for early creditworthiness.

Why it matters: Creates a positive financial identity beyond just expenses.

COLLEGE EXPENSES TRACKER

Problem: No visibility on allowance breakdown (food, rent, fun, tuition).

Solution: Auto-tagged transactions → clear spend categories.

Insights: “You spent ₹1,200 more on food vs peers this month.”

Early alerts: “At current pace, allowance will end by 23rd.”
Builds awareness → accountability → control.

GAMIFIED MONEY MISSIONS

Problem: Students disengage with “serious” finance apps.

Solution: Missions + rewards for savings & budgeting.

Ex: “No Spend Sunday → earn badge 🏆”

“Save ₹1,000 this month → unlock coupon 🎁”

Leaderboards: “You’re #3 in savings this month.”

Why it matters: Creates habit loops (like Duolingo streaks) → repeat app use.

SWOT & PESTEL

Analysis the companies overall metrics

